Arkavathi - Kannada Vedic Font

Introduction

Arkavathi is a modified copy of the Goda font (version 1.0.5) by the Parankusacar Institute of Vedic Studies. Goda is a derivative of the Sampige font released by the Indian Institute of Science (IISc), and borrows the Basic-Latin block (00-7F) of Doulos SIL. Goda is released under the SIL Open Font License (OFL) with the Reserved Font Name "Goda", so this copy carries a new name. The original copyright and licence notices are kept in the font.

The present initiative

The font is meant for reading and typing Vedic Kannada text with the Kannada IME (kannada_ime). Version 1.3 changes two things, has a new name, and leaves every other glyph and table of Goda as it was.

Changes from Goda

#	Change	Why
1	Vertical bars of Udatta (U+0951), Svarita and double Svarita (U+1CDA) are 1.4 times taller. The bottom edge stays in place, only the top grows. Both the Devanagari-space and the Kannada-space (non-Unicode) glyphs were changed.	Easier to read at running-text sizes.
2	The Devanagari script of the font now has the same positioning (GPOS) features as the Kannada script.	U+A8F3 is a Devanagari-block character, so a Vedic mark typed after it was shaped in a separate run that had no positioning. The mark floated or showed a dotted circle. Now it sits over the ga part of the sign.
3	Name, version and unique ID updated: family "Arkavathi", version 1.3.	Required by the OFL Reserved Font Name.

Glyph enhancements

Original Goda (left) compared with Arkavathi 1.3 (right), same text.

Text	Goda 1.0.5	Arkavathi 1.3
ka + Udatta		
ka + double Svarita		

ka + Anudatta		
ga + āgama anusvāra + Udatta		
āgama anusvāra + Udatta		

Vedic Extensions

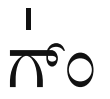
As in Goda, the Vedic signs exist in the Devanagari space (Unicode code points, used by current Windows, browsers and LibreOffice) and in the Kannada space (non-Unicode code points, for older systems).

Unicode	non-Unicode	Name	Symbol
0x951	0xCD1	udātta	
0x1CDA	0xCBB	dīrgha svarita	
0x952	0xCD2	anudātta	
0xA8F3	0xCD3	āgama anusvāra	
0xA8F4	0xCD4	dvirbhūta lupta āgamānusvāra	
0x1CF2	0xCF1	jihvāmūlīya	
0x1CF3	0xCF2	upadhmānīya	

In the symbol column the first three are shown on the letter ಕ. U+A8F3 is a complete sign: it already contains the ga, so it is not typed after ಗ.

Typing with kannada_ime

Keys	Result	Meaning
ka '		Udatta

`ka_`		Anudatta
`ka" or ka^^`		double Svarita
`kaM'`		anusvara, then Udatta
`gM'`		āgama anusvāra + Udatta (replaces the ga)
`gaM`		ordinary anusvara
`MM`		āgama anusvāra on its own

Output order is always: letter, vowel sign, anusvara or visarga, Vedic mark. Use `'` (Shift+#), `"` (Shift+2) and _ (Shift+-) on a German keyboard.

Installing and using

Close programs that use the font, uninstall any earlier "Arkavathi" in Windows Settings, Fonts, then double-click the .ttf and choose Install. Select "Arkavathi" as the font in your editor, browser or Word.

Known limits

Windows Notepad does not apply OpenType positioning, so Vedic marks look misplaced there; use a browser, Word, LibreOffice or VS Code. Anudatta sits at Goda's original depth (far below plain letters on purpose, so it clears subscripts). U+A8F4, U+1CF2 and U+1CF3 come from Goda unchanged and have no typing key yet.

Licence

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